

TECHNICAL REPORT WRITING (TRW) (Basics)

CHAPTER NO 2 DEFINING AUDIENCES

Chapter 2 in a Nutshell

(Analyze the audience before you write)

- Who are they? Find out who your audience is.
- How much do they know about the topic/subject?
- What do they expect? Determine their expectations.

How much does your audience know about the topic?

(Key Activity) ★

Two Main kinds of audience on the basis of their existing knowledge.

1. Expert Audience
2. Lay Audience

Find out what your audience knows

- Ask them before you write
- Ask them after you write
- Ask someone else
- Consider the audience's position
- Consider prior contacts

Adapt to your audience's knowledge level

- Build on their schemata
- For a more knowledgeable audience
- For a less knowledgeable audience

Know the audience's role in a situation

To determine role of your audience ask yourself these questions

Who will read this document?

- A single person (May be your supervisor)
- A small group (Members of a committee)
- A large group (Readers of a user manual)
- Primary audience (person actually addressed in the document)
- Secondary audience (someone other than the receiver)

Other points to consider the audience's role

- What is the audience's need?
- How does the writer's goal fulfil the audience's need?
- What is the audience's task?

What are the audience's community attitudes?

To determine these attitudes ask yourself the following questions

- What consequences will occur from this idea?
- What is the history of this idea?
- How much power does the reader have?
- How formal is the situation?
- How does the reader feel about the subject?
- How does the reader feel about the sender?
- What form does the reader expect?

